



Fast Track Love

I have been reading *Digit* for a year, and am eagerly waiting for your seventh anniversary issue. You are the best among all the other tech magazines, and I love your CD / DVD, Fast Tracks, and magazine. I will soon be subscribing to *Digit* for three years, and I thought I should write to you and tell you that last month's *Digit* was amazing. *The Fast Track to Google Sketchup* was very useful for an architect like me, and has made me fall in love with *Digit*. Please keep rocking India, and keep up the good work.

Saurabh Kumar

We received a lot of positive feedback about the *Fast Track to Google Sketchup*, both from budding architects, as well as those with a passion for design and engineering drawing. We will try our best to find more such topics. Suggestions are always welcome.

Team Digit

Ridiculous!

I have been reading your fantastic magazine for the past 3 years, but this is the first time I am writing to you. I started reading your magazine in May 2005, when I was in the 9th grade. I bought your first issue from Nainital, where I was holidaying at the time (I actually live in Mumbai). There's been no turning back, and I would like to thank you and give you full credit for all that I know about computers. I have earned the reputation of "computer geek" amongst my friends, thanks to you, and I am sought after about computers. I can help my friends and give them detailed replies thanks to *Digit*.

The magnitude of gratefulness that I feel towards you is something I can't express in words; thanks a lot! All your issues and fast tracks have been the best ever, and no amount of competition can ever defeat the fact that you are the best. It's all thanks to you that I have been able to assemble my dream AMD gaming rig, with an AMD Phenom 9550 processor and a 780G chipset-based board. I have also assembled and sold a computer, all thanks to you! I loved the article about the technology used to send probes to Mars, as well as the Fast Tracks to Tech Jargon, Wireless Networking and The Web. Congrats on being India's No 1 tech magazine, and the World's best magazine for me.

It's not all praise though, and I must state that I feel that you are biased towards Intel processors. I feel that AMD has much better products than Intel, and is far superior in terms of price and performance. I feel that Intel and ATi have disappeared from the *Digit* world.

In your Zero1 awards, you stated that "there has not been much action from the AMD Phenom processors", but I feel it's because of all the Intel-sponsored reviews on the Net, which pitted the Intel Quads against the Phenoms on NVIDIAs 590 SLIs. Had the reviews been done on an AMD 7xxx chipset, which are specially designed for the AMD Phenoms, it would be a different story. It's a known fact that the Phenoms provide unto 30 per cent better performance on an AMD 7 series chipset.

The Phenom gives me beautiful performance, excellent on even high-end games like Portal and Far cry at FULL detail, right out of the box—any time greater than an Intel Core 2 Quad on a G35 chipset. Sometimes I feel that you are being paid a good amount by Intel to advertise their inferior products, because one of your competitors reviewed and rated the Athlon 64 X2s much greater than most Core 2 duos, and those ratings seemed genuine. I surely hope that I am wrong, but I am telling you how I feel.

Please continue your good work, and keep on giving us wonderful magazines.

Abheek Gulati
Mumbai

This is the first time anyone has ever accused us of being biased in our tests! The idea that we'd take a little money to make one product win over another is so ludicrous that we're still finding it hard to believe.

To begin with, we're not quite sure what sites you have been reading up on, but we can tell you that you should un-bookmark them. It's no secret to the world that the Core 2 series from Intel has done to AMD exactly what AMDs Athlon64 series did to Intel's Pentium 4 series. If you go back and look at older *Digit* issues, you will see that we are completely unbiased, and as long as Athlons ruled the roost, it was all that we ever recommended to people. Part of the fun of working for *Digit* is to know that we're not some fly-by-night little Web site that is looking to make money or scandals, but a company that for the past decade has been known to have the most fair and unbiased Test Centre in India. We have even lost advertisers based on the fact that we have attacked sub-standard products from companies that are considered tech giants, and it's still not phased us one bit.

As for the Phenom, yes it is a nice processor, and does quite well against the Core 2 Quads of similar pricing. It still loses most benchmarks, even on the AMD 7xxx platform. Add to this the fact that the Penryn and newer Core 2s are based on a 45-nm fab, which means

lower power, less heat and still higher clock speeds, and you can see why we recommend Core 2s for performance junkies. As for those on a budget, we do recommend AMD's offerings, because the fight between Intel and AMD means that you get a nice big discount on some very nice AMD processors. A couple of years ago, the roles were reversed, and it was Pentium 4s that were the budget offerings.

As for *Portal* and *Far Cry*, they're not even close to as CPU intensive as say, *Crysis* is, and they stress the graphics sub-system more than a CPU. Any current generation dual-core CPU should allow you to play both of these without any framing at "FULL detail", providing you have a good graphics card! I suggest that you do a little more research online about how to benchmark CPUs, and then try a comparison of your own, with all the strict testing guidelines that any good reviewer adheres to.

In our 7 years as *Digit*, and even before that, we have received tonnes of both positive and negative feedback, and we have to admit that yours is, by far, the most insulting and heartbreaking letter of all time! The only thing that would seem more preposterous now is if someone wrote in and accused us of accepting bribes from Microsoft to promote Linux and Open Source!

Team Digit

Break It Up

I have only been buying *Digit* for the last six months, but I'm in the process of reading the 30 older issues that my elder brother has collected. Although, I also have a lot of other

tech magazines, *Digit* fulfils all my needs.

I'm not a geek, but I am a technology freak, and am addicted to it. So while I'm busy filling up my hard drive (my mind) with technology knowledge about hardware and software from *Digit*, I thought I should thank you with this letter. Please show my

letter to all the *Digit* staff as my thanks for their great effort towards distributing tech knowledge and making India a better and more intelligent place to live in.

I have only one complaint, which is about the design of the magazine. I think your articles should be divided much better visually, with breaks so as not to look like long essays. The only other thing I can think of is the poor quality of the DVDs, which has gone down regularly—the quality of the discs, not the content. Apart from this, you're all doing a perfect job.

Apoorva Rai
Varanasi



Write to the Editor

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The staff thanks you for appreciating our work. We do have both short and long stories, depending on what the subject demands. It's important that some subjects be covered comprehensively, and that's why you feel that some stories are too long. We will do our best to make them feel shorter, visually at least. As for the DVD contents, it would help a lot if you told us what you don't like, or at least what sort of content you do like.

Note: We request our readers to be more specific in their feedback so that we can pinpoint what you like and what you don't!

Team Digit

Yeh Dil Maange More

Hello fellow tech-holics, who live for the best thing on this planet—technology. I have been reading *Digit* for over 4 years now, and I have only one word for it—AWESOME! Your unattractive subscription offers, however, have stopped me from subscribing. Although not perfect, *Digit* is still the best tech magazine in India. From your 7th anniversary onwards I hope you will get rid of some issues that have nagged us:

Paper and print quality, timely availability in smaller cities like Ranchi, better software in the DVD, newer movies, better music, less Linux, more on education, more mobile content, mention game minimum system requirements on the DVD, and a *Fast Track to Programming*.

Arighna Mitra
Ranchi

Now that's the way to suggest improvements! Just rattle them out without wasting any words. You have our assurance that we will try and meet most of your demands in a couple of months. As for the newer movies, which seems to be a common request, we think you guys are getting the wrong idea. Although we do provide a blockbuster, latest movie in some special issues, we're *not* trying to get you to believe that the regular vintage movies we provide are a substitute for that.

We're quite well aware that the movies we provide are from the 1920s to 1950s, and we're providing them for nostalgic reasons. It's important to know your history, and these are the history of the entertainment industry. We we're the first to offer you movies, and we were also the first to take a step back in time and reminisce. Just as Mozart and Beethoven are classical musicians, we're hoping you will learn to appreciate these classic movies. Besides, they hardly waste any DVD space...

Team Digit

Whatever Happened To?

On Page 59, the last tip ("Archive archive archive") ends abruptly. I expect such things from others, but not from *Digit*. You also held an opinion poll about the Fast Track being made colour, with better paper quality—whatever happened to that? Please make the Q&A section bigger, or at least publish all reader queries online. Also, more articles to educate people about the risks they put themselves in while pirating would be good.

Sridhar Rao

Whoops! Apologies. We'll certainly try not to let such idiotic errors happen again. As for the *Fast Track*, we're working on something that we feel all our readers will like. And we're trying to make sure we can do it without raising the price of the magazine. You'll find out soon enough.

Team Digit

Nobody's Perfect

I appreciate the effort Team Digit puts into every issue to satisfy our tech hunger. I've been a reader for the past 5 months, and I am greatly impressed with *Digit*. However, I already have a few complaints.

Please start international subscriptions at low rates for countries around India. I am from Nepal, and I have to spend NPR 200 (One Indian Rupee is 1.6 Nepalese Rupees) which is too much for a student like me. Please also make sure that the *Take A Crack* section is included in every issue. Give us more Fast Track books to programming and Linux. Please improve the paper quality, because *Digit* goes through a lot of weathering and transportation to reach us in Nepal.

Of course, nobody's perfect, and these feel like minor issues when compared to the information you offer, but please consider them and keep up the good work.

Pravesh Koirala
Janakpur, Nepal

At a conversion rate of 1:1.6, Indian Rs 125 works out to NPR 200 exactly. You're paying exactly what our Indian readers are paying, and we think it would be unfair to price a magazine that's made in India at a cheaper rate in another country. We will try and look into a subscription scheme to allow you to save some money though. Stay tuned.

Team Digit

Phat-Being!

Hello Uncle Chandiramani! I am 14 years old and recently started reading *Digit*. The articles you wrote were very interesting, and really had a lot of information about the latest gadgets. When I get *Digit*, I always read your articles first. The contents of the DVD and CD that you make are also amazing. They have helped me personalise Windows, and tune my system. I'm the first amongst my friends to be introduced to DTP, Web, Programming, etc.

The only thing I dislike is gaming, because it takes away our creativity, and there is nothing obtained except fun. I started making HTML pages last year, and recently completed Visual Basic on my own. I request you to give us more programming stuff (for VB, HTML, C++, etc) like source codes, tools, etc. I also secretly request you to provide software such as ResHacker and hex editors so that I can hack into EXE and DLL files, and I also want links for free software Web-sites. Thank you my dear Uncle!

Raavi Munaf Bhatkar
Ratnagiri

Dear Raavi, Team Digit would like to thank you for finally giving us something to rag good old "Uncle Chandiramani" about. You have no idea how hard it is to find flaws with Nimish, or "Fatbeing", as he calls himself. He's one of our best writers, toasts an excellent DVD, and makes fun of his one weakness—food—himself! Thanks to your letter, many of us have finally got a chance to give him some of his own. He's a good sport though, and will definitely heed your suggestions for the DVD. We're just hoping that you're asking for sites to download "freeware" from, and not the other kind of *free* software!

Team Digit

Corrigendum

In last month's issue, on page 87 in the LCD test tables, the Editor's Pick award (LG L246WP) erroneously read "April 2008" and should have read May 2008.

In the Hard Drive test of the same month, on page 93, the Seagate Barracuda 7200.11 750 GB was awarded the Editor's Pick award, but here too, the month was wrongly displayed as April 2008 instead of May 2008. Our apologies for any confusion this might have caused.

